



◀ **SWIMMING** *Nothosaurus* probably swam like an otter, waving its long, powerful tail to drive itself through the water. The webbed feet were better suited to walking on land than swimming, but they may have helped

Nothosaurus make sharp twists and turns as it chased its prey.

Nothosaurus

NO-tho-SORE-us

- **When** 240–210 million years ago (Early to Late Triassic)
- **Fossil location** Europe, N. Africa, Russia, China
- **Habitat** Oceans
- **Length** 4–13 ft (1.2–4 m)
- **Diet** Fish

Like a seal, *Nothosaurus* hunted in the water but probably came ashore to rest. It had amazingly long and needle-sharp teeth to seize fish. The teeth interlocked to form a cage, trapping prey in the mouth. *Nothosaurus* had a long and muscular neck. Some experts think it could twist its head sideways like a crocodile to grab passing fish—a trick known as “snap feeding.”

